Alcaraz Beats Shelton to Win His First Paris Masters Title

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Carlos Alcaraz waited 60 days for his chance to play Ben Shelton again. Back in September, Shelton beat him in a long, **five-set** match at the US Open. That match ended Alcaraz's **comeback** tournament. On Sunday in Paris, Alcaraz got his revenge. The 23-year-old from Spain beat Shelton, the world number four, 7-6 (7-5), 7-5. It was his first Paris Masters title.

The first set was close. Alcaraz saved all six **break points** against him. Then, in the **tie-break**, he was behind 4-3 but won four of the last five points to take the set. Shelton broke first in the second set, but Alcaraz fought back when Shelton was serving for a 5-3 lead. He even danced to the music in the stadium. Alcaraz won the title on his second **match point**.

Alcaraz had missed four months with a wrist injury before the US Open. Since losing to Shelton, he has won three titles and lost only once in 17 matches. This is his ninth ATP Masters 1000 title. Next, he will play at the ATP Finals in Turin.

Word Treasure

break points -- A chance for the other player to win the game while you are serving.

tie-break -- A short extra part of a set that decides the winner when the score is tied.

comeback -- A return to playing after being away, often because of an injury.

match point -- The last point a player needs to win the whole match.

five-set -- A match that can last up to five sets, so it can go on for a long time.

Background you need

Tennis matches are played in parts called sets, and a player must win enough sets to win the match.

The Paris Masters is a big tennis event in Paris where top players compete for a title.

Alcaraz had missed four months with a wrist injury before the US Open, and this match was his chance to beat Shelton after losing to him there.

Break it down

WHO: Carlos Alcaraz from Spain and Ben Shelton, the world number four.
WHAT: Alcaraz beat Shelton 7-6 (7-5), 7-5 to win his first Paris Masters title.
WHERE: In Paris, in a stadium.
WHY: Alcaraz wanted revenge after Shelton beat him at the US Open in September.

Why it matters

It shows that if you keep practicing after a loss or an injury, you can come back and win.

Test what you remember

1. Who did Alcaraz beat in the Paris final?

- (A) The world number one
- (B) A player from France
- (C) A player from Spain
- (D) Ben Shelton

2. What was the score of the match?

- (A) 6-4, 6-4
- (B) 6-7, 7-6, 6-4
- (C) 7-5, 6-3
- (D) 7-6 (7-5), 7-5

3. How many break points did Alcaraz save in the first set?

- (A) Three
- (B) Two
- (C) Six
- (D) Four

4. What happened in the tie-break of the first set?

- (A) Alcaraz lost it 7-5
- (B) Alcaraz was behind 4-3 but won four of the last five points
- (C) Shelton won it easily
- (D) The set ended without a tie-break

5. Why was this match special for Alcaraz?

- (A) He had never played in Paris before
- (B) It was his first tennis match
- (C) It was his first Paris Masters title
- (D) It was his tenth Paris Masters title

6. What will Alcaraz do next?

- (A) Take four months off
- (B) Play at the US Open
- (C) Retire from tennis
- (D) Play at the ATP Finals in Turin

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: D 3: C 4: B 5: C 6: D

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):